

April 2010

T L DIRECT

The Line Direct

OUR CORE VALUES

A few weeks ago, posters appeared on the walls of our offices and factories, presenting, in several languages, what we consider as our core values.

The identification and writing of these values has not been an easy trivial exercise. It has taken a fair amount of time, attention, and many persons of our group brought their contribution.

One important goal was to avoid enumerating artificial stereotypes, but truly transcribe the values in which we recognize ourselves.

We are obviously far from being perfect, and some of the principles exposed on these posters are probably more those towards which we wish to tend, rather than today's strict reality.

It has appeared important to us to put in writing what we are, what we want to be, and how we wish to work and to behave in our companies.

The values thus transcribed are inspiring for all, and in particular for the new ones who can learn there from some essential aspects of our corporate culture. Lastly, they must be opposable to all within our group.

Jean-Marie FULCONIS

OUR CORE VALUES

We stand behind our customers and products: responsibility, support and continuous improvement are the key words which drive our work and attitude.



We promote reactivity, diligence and responsiveness in action and communication.



We treat fairly the people and partners whom we employ and deal with and value open door communication and transparency.



We promote an open mind attitude, welcome new ideas and accept being constructively challenged.



We respect diversity and value the contribution of a multicultural spirit.



We favor a medium and long term approach rather than short term driven decisions.



We value innovation, creativity and believe in the virtues of thinking "out of the box".



We believe that management must be demanding, positive and nurturing, while caring about the development and training of our employees.



We value employees' empowerment, which calls on their sense of responsibility.



As a lean organization, we look for efficient and cost conscious solutions to achieve our tasks and promote benchmarking and experience sharing.



We believe in work as an essential way to achieve success, and we aim at building a work environment which fosters individual growth and personal achievement.



We value a hands-on attitude throughout our organization. We believe in doing things, and selectively getting into details, as part of the management mission and as a sign of its deep involvement.

REACHING NEW HEIGHTS



The Latest Dispatch

From EUREKA to BaaN



Started at the end of 2008 this project becomes a reality in 2010. TLD EUROPE has joined the BaaN community!

ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning) is the heart of the Information system of the company and helps manage Logistics & Finance transactions within and outside the company. The purpose of the project was to achieve a new convergence step within our TLD organization in order to increase the standardization of our tools, ease exchanges between TLD companies and simplify the development of Web intranet tools that pull data from ERP.

On 1/1/2010 TLD EUROPE migrated from previous EUREKA ERP to BaaN ERP now common, to all TLD GSE companies of the TLD Group. This successful move was made possible thanks to the hard work of a dedicated team composed of TLD EUROPE Pilots, TLD Group MIS Team, TLD Counterparts, Consultants under the supervision of a steering committee composed of A. Maguin, H. Criquillion, G. Fong, G. Edbrooke, J.L. Richard and J.P. Delaite.

TLD EUROPE Pilots : Celine Tessier, Carine Romain, Virginie Diagne, Helene Durvaux, Sarah Vally, Olivier Guibert, David Bellavance, Thierry Leon have achieved a great job during the past 8 months to make this happen, learning the new software, teaching end-users and doing their own job at the same time.

This Pilots team has been supported by TLD MIS team including Gary Edbrooke who has covered all the logistics settings and migration tasks with the help of Jean-Louis Richard. Gary has spent a lot of time in France for this project and especially 3 weeks of a hard work at migration time, away from his family.

TLD Europe sister companies were also involved with counterparts appointed for the project and some other skilled people who joined us along the project. All these people brought valuable help and support for benchmarking and training Europe pilots (through email, phone call, receiving EUROPE pilots on their site or visiting EUROPE Pilots in France).

Bull, a French consultant, main BaaN integrator in France has taken an active part of the project for all trainings and for Finance settings as well as RMC an American consultant for some specific developments.

Managing ourselves this project, using internal resources as much as possible, applying various tax incentives applicable to such project with the help of Human Resources, we then achieved this project with cost conscious solutions.

All GSE-BU will take advantage of some studies and improvements developed during the BaaN Europe's project while constructively challenging existing TLD BaaN procedures.

This project has been one of the major TLD transverse project ever made, indeed it has proven the capacity of TLD teams to be involved in such a huge challenging project despite the difficulties. Through this project we have had the great opportunity to communicate and share experience with TLD colleagues all over the world.

MANY THANKS TO ALL CONTRIBUTORS

Jean-Paul DELAITE

TLD Life Digest

Technician on Call “TOC”

If we were to climb aboard the TLD time machine and transport ourselves back two years ago to the IAS GSE shop in Mather, CA, there is a good chance we might find a TLD technician under a 929 elevator in the middle of a repair. With sweat on his brow and his hands covered in grease his cell phone rings with an incoming call from a customer in crisis mode desperately needing technical assistance. The TLD tech wants to take the call but just can't at that moment. He will have to wait until later to call this customer back. He hopes the customer can wait also.

An hour goes by, and the tech returns the call to the customer who is now a little more upset because he has tried to reach two other TLD techs on their cell phones and could not reach anyone. (They were in the field working on equipment as well.) His attitude does not improve when after describing his problem, the TLD tech informs him that he will call him back after he returns to the hotel that night and can access schematics on-line.

Out of these painful experiences the TLD Tech-on-Call (TOC) program was born. The TOC program is designed to provide tools to more effectively respond to customer support needs, build skill levels of TLD technicians, and at the same time develop valuable information to assist TLD in providing better products for customers.

Each week a senior technician is responsible for fielding all technical questions from the field. These technical questions may come from a customer or another TLD employee. For each question that comes in, a TOC entry is made in a log. Each log entry is linked to either a Service Record or a Warranty Claim depending on the type of assistance required. The TOC is constantly updating this log and all the records that are linked to it, until either they solve the problem or request from the Service Manager that a technician be dispatched to solve the problem.

Once a TOC log entry has been made for an issue or question, the only way the log can be moved to a “solved” status is for the TOC to follow up with the customer and confirm that the piece of equipment has been repaired and is back in service.

The pilot TOC program began in July of 2008 with the TOC log detailed on an Excel spreadsheet with hyperlinks to the Service Module. The Excel log was an effective way to manage the program during these early days while learning what information was needed at the TOC's fingertips. However, in order for the TOC program to grow into a Group-wide tool, it needed to move to the TLD website which was accomplished in November of 2009.

Since its beginning in North America in July of 2008, a total of 1,500 entries have been recorded, and since its inception Group-wide in the last four months, over 500 entries to the TOC log have been recorded.



TLD Life Digest

Since its beginning in North America in July of 2008, a total of 1,500 entries have been recorded, and since its inception Group-wide in the last four months, over 500 entries to the TOC log have been recorded.

Major benefits realized from the program are the immediate and tracked responses to customer needs. Hundreds of Service Records and Warranty Claims have been recorded that before the program would not have been opened. These records help TLD build data bases of valuable information for both the customer and TLD.

Feedback on the program has been very positive. Particularly impressive to our customers is the follow-up call that confirms resolution of their problem. Technicians participating in the weekly rotation of TOC are better connected within the company as they pool information from PSM's, Engineering, Service Managers, other technicians, TLD vendor technicians, TLD vendor engineers, etc. to answer the questions of the customer. This inner connection to information and interaction with the customers as they solve problems builds the TLD tech's skills making the TLD support team more proficient in repairing equipment.

Today a TLD customer needing assistance may still elect to call directly to a tech's cell phone, and if the technician is available, he will take the call and answer the question. However, if unavailable, the tech's voicemail message points the customer to the TOC. Of course the customer can also call the TOC direct line.

That disgruntled customer of two years ago will now have his call immediately answered or returned within minutes. He will feel the veil of support that has been pulled down around him as the TOC asks questions and helps him with advice. The customer's confidence in his skill level and in TLD increases with this newfound knowledge as he quickly returns the equipment to service. Several days later he receives an inquiry regarding the status of his equipment, and he is further impressed with the level of dedication exhibited by a company that not only supported him in his hour of need, but took the time to ensure he was happy and that the unit was back in his operation.

TLD "Reaching New Heights"
Michael RAWLS & MarK BLALOCK

The last development of TLD Saint Lin

After the delivery of 48 electric loaders TXL-737-E to Air France, TLD Saint Lin has developed the new diesel version of this equipment. The selected motorization is a 3 cylinders Deutz engine, allowing a cost reduction and a reduction in fuel burn. The prototype was finished in October 2009 and has been delivered to an important customer, and more orders have been received since then. This new diesel version integrates all the improvements of the electric version, with an increased accessibility to the engine pack compared to the former 727 loader.



A major project of the end of 2009 has been the maintenance platform. After having delivered 24 maintenance platforms for Airbus A340 in France, a French customer consulted us for 8 maintenance platform for the Airbus **A380**.

The main new characteristics are an increase in dimensions in order to reach an elevation of 7,30 meters.



The other major characteristic is the conformity to ATEX standard (explosiveness in closed circle, during aircraft maintenance). This development enabled us to design an innovating sensitive bumper (engine contact detection), each platform being equipped with 27 extension drawers... Delivery of the 8 units is scheduled in April 2010. The maintenance platform for Airbus A340 and A380 are now available for sale after factory consultation.

3 other evolutions are to be noted for Saint Lin products:

- The ABS-580 canopy was redesigned, after the emission of 3 Product Demerit Claims. The goal is to reduce the risks of leak and wear of the cap cover.
- As from May 2010, the JET-16 cabin will be manufactured by Buisard, which is the French supplier of the Ranger cabin. In addition to the cost reduction, the black colour will become the base again, and the reliability of the locks is largely improved.
- Lastly, available as of March 2010, the motopump of the ABS-E and NBL-E are now brushless (same technology to the JET-16), and therefore does not require maintenance.

In conclusion, 2010 planned developments are directed by the evolution of the European standards, and mainly in term of safety. This will lead to two versions of the ABS-580, the standard version, and the CE version with rigid barrier on platform, as well as to a major redesign of the ambulift range.

Nicolas VERIN

The Last Development in China

TLD Sales and Services Organization in China

China is evolving into a significant market for aviation and for GSE. There are 167 airports for commercial airlines by end of 2009. The State Council plans to increase the number to 244 by 2020. In addition, many airports in China were built in the 70's and require major upgrade to cope with the increase passengers flow and accommodate wide body aircrafts.

In order to capture the opportunities and position well in the market, TLD has set up three offices in Beijing, Shanghai and Guangzhou. Currently, China SSO has 29 staff to serve the major airlines such as Air China, China Eastern, China Southern and airports such as Beijing Capital Airport, Pudong and Hong Qiao airports in Shanghai and Guangzhou Baiyun Airport. There is also growing importance of regional/budget airlines such as Hainan, Spring, Jixiang, Chongqing and airports in the second and third tier cities for example Hangzhou, Nanjing, Xi'an, Chengdu, Kunming etc. To focus our effort in the regional airports, we have assigned one ASM to handle these opportunities in the North and West regions.

In February, we moved our Beijing office from the city to the airport area. We are now much closer to our customers in Beijing.



It takes only 10 minutes drive to get to their offices. We have 9 people in this office, four of them are ASM plus three service technicians. This office covers almost half of the country in terms of geographic area. In Shanghai, we have 14 people in the office, two ASM's, one service manager plus 4 service technicians. We also have a Spare Parts Hub with 5 people. Guangzhou office has an ASM, one assistant and two service technicians.



We were awarded a service contract with UPS Shenzhen in January. We provide both preventive maintenance and emergency break down services to their whole GSE fleet. We set up a team of three people to provide round the clock service to this global customer.

We will handover two TPX-500-MTS to China Eastern in May which they plan to service A-380 passenger flights from Lufthansa in Shanghai Pudong airport. These two towbarless tractors will be the first of its kind that is capable to service A-380 in this airport.

The Last Development in China

Despite the number of international visitors travel to China and cargo for export has dropped in 2009 due to global economic crisis, China remains a very promising market. Domestic passenger and cargo traffic increased over 8% in 2009 compared with 2008. We were very busy in submitting tenders and quotations to customers in Q4, 2009. We start the year with a backlog equivalent to 20% of our 2010 budget which is a good start of the year. Our order inputs for January and February were low due to Chinese New Year holidays, as it is the case very year. Nevertheless, we are back on track starting in late February which we have been awarded 12 GPU , four 838 loaders and one TPX-200-MT from Air China which will be our first towbarless tractor breakthrough into this important account. We also secured orders for jet starters for three regional airports. We strongly believe that as long as we are persistent and continue to provide world class products and services to our customers, we will maintain our position as a major contributor to the development of the aviation industry in China.



Chris TAM

TLD people

WHEN ECONOMIC CRISIS GOES HAND IN HAND WITH SOCIAL INNOVATION AND THE ENHANCEMENT OF QUALIFICATIONS

The unprecedented economic crisis that we have been suffering since the autumn of 2008 is paradoxically an opportunity for social innovation and an enhancement of workers' qualifications.

This requires us to be creative and to avoid the standard solutions as much as possible, solutions such as mass short-term unemployment or adaptation to available resources (orders in sharp decline) leading to mass redundancies.

One of the roles of the HR department is to adapt the individual to the company, that is to say ensuring that the workers are sufficiently competent for the conception, production and distribution of products and services responding to the market's and our clients' demands for quality.

Satisfaction of clients, profits from new markets, maintenance of profit margins and improving quality control are all vital for the commercial and business plan.

It is elsewhere on this axis of management and certification of qualifications that the ISO auditors carry out their tests (at the heart of the HR department) when it comes to the annual certification audits.

TLD people

At TLD EUROPE, in the autumn of 2009, the legal provisions specific to our sector (metallurgy), the bonuses received and the organisation of the internal training have allowed us to seize the crisis as an opportunity for cohesion, social innovation and enhancement and certification of workers' qualifications.

Twenty-four people followed a personalised training programme for a total of more than 2,000 hours (around 12 days per person) giving them a 'Mechanical Assembler-Fitter'(CQPM) professional certification. This certification is delivered by a jury of external professionals and is nationally recognised in France.

This training amounted to a total cost of around €100,000 (including teaching expenses and time spent in training). Thanks to effective research into bonuses available for training, this has in the end only had a very marginal cost for TLD EUROPE.

To this day we have avoided mass redundancies, created a workforce temporarily over qualified for the factories, developed versatility, raised the level of workers' qualifications in accordance with ISO 9001 standards and strengthened cohesion within teams. This training will be continued in 2010 and the number of trainees increased to 30 people. In the medium term the objective is to have certified qualifications for all workers (engine fitters, industrial painters...).

Creativity, innovation and cohesion, three key words that have guided the HR department of TLD EUROPE – in these times of crisis – in its role of support to the operations and of alleviation of the effects of the crisis.

Nicolas COURTIER

The Latest Dashboard

T L Dash board (in M€uros)

(Year to date-end of MARCH figures)

TLD Sales	2010-03		2010/2009 % Evolution
	in M€uros	in % of total	
GSE - AREA AMERICA (Americas, Australia, Japan, N. Zealand)	8,0	32,3%	<1,3>%
GSE - AREA EUROPE (Europe, Africa, middle east, India, Pakistan)	10,7	43,4%	<45,4>%
GSE - AREA ASIA	2,6	10,7%	<41,0>%
Other activities (Adhésives solutions)	3,3	13,5%	<6,8>%
TOTAL TLD SALES	24,7	100%	<31,1>%

